

RISKS

Constitution Propagation — RISKS

Note on filenames. The staged carrier drafts in this directory are stored with a `.staged` suffix (e.g. `AGENTS.md.staged`). The constitution’s propagation gates discover carriers by exact filename (`CLAUDE.md`, `AGENTS.md`, `QWEN.md`, `GEMINI.md`), so drafts named that way inside the repo are counted as real carriers and fail the gate. Drop the `.staged` suffix when you copy a file into its target submodule.

Field	Value
Revision	2
Created	2026-08-26
Last modified	2026-08-27
Status	active
Status summary	Blast-radius, exclusion and honesty register for the propagation prepared in <code>APPLY.md</code> . Nothing has been applied. Every number below comes from a read-only command whose output is quoted. Revision 2 (2026-08-27) adds §0: the Revision-1 staging was defective and would have regressed the constitution gates; it has been rewritten and the fix measured in <code>PROOF.md</code> .

Continuation

Field	Value
	Operator reads this — §0 first — before executing APPLY.md §4.

0. Revision 1 of this staging was defective — recorded, not quietly fixed

The Revision-1 files in this directory would have made the constitution gates strictly worse if applied. This is recorded here rather than silently corrected, because an operator who read Revision 1’s APPLY.md and acted on it would have been worse off for it.

0.1 The defect

Every CM-COVENANT-114-*-PROPAGATION gate sources one predicate, submodules/constitution/scripts/gates/lib/pointer_carrier.sh. It recognises a §11.4.35 pointer consumer — a carrier allowed to omit the anchor literals — iff the file contains a **line-anchored, non-fenced ## INHERITED FROM heading at column zero**:

```
!fenced && /^## INHERITED FROM / { found = 1; exit }
```

The Revision-1 drafts opened with a > blockquote (AGENTS.md, QWEN.md, GEMINI.md, QWEN.insert-block.md) or with # CLAUDE.md – <module> followed by ## Helix Constitution inheritance (CLAUDE.md). None of those matches. None of the drafts carried a single one of the 17 anchor literals either. So every applied file would have registered as a **new anchor-less carrier** and **added** 17 MISSING verdicts of its own.

0.2 What it would have cost, measured

Run in temp directories mirroring the real fleet, with the 17 real gates (PROOF.md has the full output):

Scenario	MISSING carriers	MISSING lines	17 gates
live repository today	5	85	all FAIL
APPLY.md §4.6 with the Revision-1 files	8	136	all FAIL, louder

Scenario	MISSING carriers	MISSING lines	17 gates
APPLY.md §4.2 – §4.6 with the Revision-1 files	24	408	all FAIL, louder
APPLY.md §4.6 with the Revision-2 files	4	68	all FAIL (third-party only)
APPLY.md §4.2 – §4.6 with the Revision-2 files	4	68	all FAIL (third-party only)

The 136 / 8 row reproduces `GATE-TRIAGE.md` §6.1’s prediction exactly. It was correct.

0.3 What was changed in Revision 2

- All 19 *.md.staged carriers were rewritten. Each now opens with its H1 title and, immediately under it, the canonical **## INHERITED FROM constitution/<BASE>** heading — the form the constitution’s own examples use and the form the four repository-root carriers that pass all 17 gates use.
- `vasic.digital/QWEN.insert-block.md` was replaced by a block that starts with that heading, so the file it is inserted into becomes a pointer carrier and **leaves** the MISSING set. All 55 existing lines of `vasic.digital/QWEN.md` are preserved — verified by a zero-deletion diff on the produced file.
- The substance the previous author argued for correctly is kept: the inheritance is stated **conditionally** (consumed-inside-a-project vs. consumed-standalone), the constitution is located with `find_constitution.sh` rather than a path, and **no** depth-dependent or parent-project path is hardcoded — the heading’s `constitution/<BASE>` is stated in the carrier itself to be the base file’s canonical *name*, resolved by the helper, not a filesystem path. §11.4.28(B) is intact; `APPLY.md` §5’s own `grep` for `submodules/constitution` finds nothing in any carrier.
- `APPLY.md` §1’s tree listing now shows the `.staged` suffixes, and its §4 `cp` commands now copy **from** `<name>.md.staged` (Revision 1’s commands copied from a source filename that does not exist).
- `APPLY.md` §4.6 no longer instructs copying anchor-less carriers, carries the corrected insertion line numbers (the block grew from 17 to 48 lines, so the original body now resumes at line 51, not 20),

and ends with a `is_pointer_carrier` check on all four produced files.

- `APPLY.md` §5 gained two checks — the per-file predicate check and a fleet-level MISSING-count check — precisely because their absence is what let Revision 1 ship.

0.4 What Revision 2 does not claim

It does not make the 17 gates pass. Four category-(c) third-party carriers (`GATE-TRIAGE.md` §3.1, §7) hold every one of them FAILing and nothing in this directory can clear them. The claim is narrower and measured: the propagation stops adding failures and removes one (`vasic.digital/QWEN.md`) — 85 MISSING lines → 68, five MISSING carriers → four.

1. What was and was not done while preparing this

Not run, anywhere: `git add`, `git commit`, `git push`, `git fetch`, `git pull`, `git checkout`, `git submodule update`, `git tag`, `git remote add`, `git config`. No file inside any submodule working tree was created, modified, or deleted. The only writes are the files in this directory (`docs/constitution-adoption/propagation/`), all of them in the umbrella repo: 22 at Revision 1, and at Revision 2 the same 20 staged artifacts rewritten in place plus `PROOF.md` added — 23 files.

Also run for Revision 2 (all read-only): the 17

`cm_covenant_114_*_propagation.sh` gates against the live repository root and against five temp directories under the session scratchpad, plus `lib/pointer_carrier.sh --selftest` and direct `is_pointer_carrier` calls. No gate script, no library, and no submodule file was modified to produce those runs.

Observed, not caused — a concurrent auto-commit swept the rewritten drafts. This repository has an automated commit loop (`git log --oneline` shows a run of Auto-commit entries). At 2026-08-26T23:11:47Z, while Revision 2 was being prepared, a commit made outside this task (`f5626d6` Fix 3 refuted claims from independent audit ...) captured all 20 rewritten *.staged artifacts in this directory into git history. The Revision-2 work itself ran no `git add`, `git commit`, or `git push`; the files' content on disk and in HEAD is identical, so nothing was half-captured. It is recorded here because a reader comparing `git log` against this document's "no mutating git

command was run” statement would otherwise see a contradiction — and because it is the §11.4.84 working-tree-quiescence hazard in its live form: an unrelated commit absorbed in-flight edits it did not describe.

Run: `git -C <sub> ls-files, ls-files -s, remote -v, remote get-url --push --all, rev-parse, describe, status --porcelain, symbolic-ref -q, check-ignore -v, submodule status, plus cat / head / awk / grep / wc` on tracked files.

2. Push fan-out per repository

Measured with `git -C <repo> remote get-url --push --all origin` and `git -C <repo> remote -v`. “Distinct URLs” counts unique destinations, since `ai_interviewing` and `vasic.digital` configure three remote *names* that all resolve to one URL.

Repository	Remote names	git push origin push URLs	Distinct destinations
ai_interviewing	github, origin, upstream	git@github.com:milos85vasic/ai_interviewing.git	1
design-toolkit	origin	git@github.com:vasic-digital/design-toolkit.git	1
milosvasic.ru	gitflic, github, origin, upstream	git@gitflic.ru:milosvasic/milosvasic-net-v-2.git git@github.com:milos85vasic/milosvasic.net.v2.git	2
monetization	gitflic, github, gitlab, gitverse, origin, upstream	git@gitflic.ru:milosvasic/monetization.git git@github.com:milos85vasic/monetization.git git@gitlab.com:milos85vasic/monetization.git ssh://git@gitverse.ru:2222/milosvasic/monetization.git	4
vasic.digital	github, origin, upstream	git@github.com:vasic-digital/vasic-digital.github.io.git	1
umbrella vasic	github, origin, upstream	git@github.com:milos85vasic/vasic.git	1
	—	—	10

Repository	Remote names	git push origin push URLs	Distinct destinations
Total if APPLY.md §4 is fully executed submodules/constitution — NOT touched	gitflic, github, gitlab, gitverse, origin, upstream, vasic_digital_github, vasic_digital_gitlab	git@gitflic.ru:helixdevelopment/helixconstitution.git git@github.com:HelixDevelopment/HelixConstitution.git git@gitlab.com:helixdevelopment1/helixconstitution.git git@gitverse.ru:helixdevelopment/HelixConstitution.git git@github.com:vasic-digital/HelixConstitution.git git@gitlab.com:vasic-digital/HelixConstitution.git	6
	submodules/superspec — NOT touched	git@github.com:WangX0111/superspec.git	1

Single loudest number: monetization. One `git push` writes to four providers. That repository currently tracks **8 files** (`git -C monetization ls-files | wc -l → 8`); the four carriers are a 50 % increase in its content, published to GitFlic, GitHub, GitLab and GitVerse simultaneously. If any of the four is unreachable or credential-stale, the push partially succeeds — `git` pushes each URL in turn — leaving the mirrors divergent. Nothing in this preparation detects or repairs that.

design-toolkit has two parents. `git submodule status` shows it as an umbrella gitlink at `16e4e76d57ab61b5f3b46fae3372b2e6d6cc73e3`, and `git -C submodules/constitution/submodules/design-toolkit rev-parse HEAD` returns the identical SHA of the identical upstream. Committing to `design-toolkit` makes the **constitution's** recorded gitlink stale. Restoring that consistency requires a commit inside `submodules/constitution`, which fans out to the **6 URLs** in the row above — including two `vasic-digital` mirrors of a repository owned by HelixDevelopment. That step is deliberately **not prepared and not recommended blind**; it turns a 10-URL change into a 16-URL change and publishes into the shared constitution repository.

2.1 milosvasic.ru — fetch/push URL asymmetry

This one is easy to get wrong and worth reading twice.

```
$ git -C milosvasic.ru remote get-url origin
git@github.com:milos85vasic/milosvasic.ru.git
```

```
$ git -C milosvasic.ru remote get-url --push --all origin
git@gitflic.ru:milosvasic/milosvasic-net-v-2.git
git@github.com:milos85vasic/milosvasic.net.v2.git
```

.gitmodules declares this submodule's URL as git@github.com:milos85vasic/milosvasic.ru.git — and **no configured push URL writes to it**. A git push origin main publishes to milosvasic-net-v-2 (GitFlic) and milosvasic.net.v2 (GitHub) instead. Whether those three are mirrors of one repository under different names, or genuinely different repositories, **could not be verified offline** (§6). If they are not mirrors, the commit lands where the umbrella is not looking, and the next git submodule update on a fresh clone will not find the new commit.

The same shape, less severely, exists for monetization and submodules/constitution, whose origin fetch URL is a GitHub URL while their origin push URL list starts with GitFlic. There the GitHub URL is included among the push URLs, so the asymmetry is benign.

3. Third-party exclusion — submodules/superspec

Nothing is prepared for it, and nothing may be written into it.

Evidence, in order of strength:

1. **Upstream ownership.** .gitmodules maps it to git@github.com:WangX0111/superspec.git; git -C submodules/superspec remote -v confirms origin is that URL and is the *only* remote. WangX0111 is not milos85vasic, not vasic-digital, and not HelixDevelopment — the three orgs every other gitlink in .gitmodules belongs to. It is an external maintainer's repository.
2. **The constitution's own rule scopes propagation to owned submodules.** §11.4.28 is titled for owned submodules and §11.4.28(B) governs "Owned submodules"; the umbrella-side Constitution.project.md.template provides a ## Owned-submodule set section and closes it with the literal line "Third-party submodules excluded."

3. §11.4.65 excludes third-party trees explicitly.

Constitution.md:5995 heads the exclusion list “EXCLUDED (NOT subject to §11.4.65 — these are application/service source code or **third-party trees we do not own**)”, listing “Any third-party submodule NOT in the owned-submodule set”.

4. INVENTORY.md already ruled on it. §7.3’s target table ends “submodules/superspec | **none** — third-party, excluded per §4”, and §10 of its unverified table records the same conclusion with the same basis.

5. Practical harm. Writing carriers into it would mean either committing to a repository the operator does not control — a push that would be rejected, or worse, accepted into a fork the umbrella then diverges from — or carrying a permanently dirty working tree that breaks `git submodule status` cleanliness for everyone.

Note it already contains two files matching an agent-carrier name — `examples/static-landing-page/CLAUDE.md` and `examples/static-landing-page/.specify/memory/constitution.md`. Both are **vendored example fixtures inside the third-party tree**, not carriers of this project (INVENTORY.md §6.2 classifies them the same way). They are not to be edited, counted, or propagated to.

The only residual claim that is inference rather than fact is that WangX0111 is external to the operator — see §6.

4. Risks of the change itself

#	Risk	Why it exists	Mitigation in APPLY.md
R1	A carrier hardcodes the umbrella layout (<code>submodules/constitution/...</code>) and thereby violates §11.4.28(B)’s “No project-specific context, hardcoded paths”	The constitution’s own templates and README all say <code>constitution/...</code> , and the umbrella’s real path is <code>submodules/constitution/...</code> ; the naive fix is to <code>path-correct</code> , which is exactly the violation	The conditional form names the base file and <code>find_constitution.s</code> never a parent-relative path. APPLY.md §5 check 2 greps for <code>submodules/constitution</code> in every carrier and reports a hit as a violation.
R2	An <code>@constitution/CLAUDE.md</code> import	Claude Code resolves <code>@</code> imports relative to the importing file, so inside a submodule it points at	The prepared CLAUDE.md carries no import at all.

#	Risk	Why it exists	Mitigation in APPLY.md
	silently resolves to nothing	<sub>/constitution/CLAUDE.md, which never exists	APPLY.md §5 check 2 greps for a leading @constitution/.
R3	The pointer asserts inheritance that is false for a standalone clone	A cloned-alone submodule has no constitution anywhere; an unconditional “these rules apply” sentence would be a bluff in the §11.4 sense	Both sentences are conditional (“when this module is consumed inside a project that includes ...” / “When this module is consumed standalone ... only the module-local notes below apply”) — the reference implementation’s exact wording. No replacement file provided for it.
R4	Existing content in vasic.digital/QWEN.md is destroyed	The temptation is to overwrite with a clean template	APPLY.md §4.6 ships a insert-block plus a diff gate that must print nothing before the swap, and a post-apply zero-deletion diff.
R5	Parent gitlinks captured before submodule pushes land	§3 (Constitution.md:213): “Skipping step 1 produces parent commits / tags that point at old submodule HEADs without the actual source.”	APPLY.md §4.1 states the ordering; §4.7 is explicitly last.
R6	Partial multi-URL push leaves mirrors divergent	monetization (4 URLs) and milosvasic.ru (2 URLs) push to several hosts in one command; one failing host does not roll back the others	Not mitigated. The operator must re-check each provider after the push. No verification of remote state is possible offline.
R7	The new files are born §11.4.65-non-compliant	§11.4.65 requires .html + .pdf siblings for every included .md, and Constitution.md:5989	Not mitigated — no export tooling exists in this repo. APPLY.m

#	Risk	Why it exists	Mitigation in APPLY.md
		INCLUDES owned-submodule top-level README.md / CLAUDE.md / AGENTS.md; protection 1 is “A missing export is a §11.4.65 violation regardless of when the markdown was last touched”	§6 discloses it. The same deviation applies to APPLY.md, this file, and the 19 prepared carriers plus the insert block exactly as INVENTORY.md §1 disclosed for itself.
R8	The pointers are unenforced decoration	The gates that would check them (scripts/verify-governance-cascade.sh, scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh, tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh) do not exist — INVENTORY.md G3/G5. §11.4.32 (Constitution.md:2079-2082): “Without it, new rules cascade as anchors but never get enforced in the codebase.”	Not mitigated by design — this task prepares propagation only. APPLY.md §6 states it.
R9	Submodule carriers alone do not close G1/G2	The 175 CM-COVENANT-114-N-PROPAGATION gates check CLAUDE.md / AGENTS.md “across the project” (§11.4.35 invariant 5), and the umbrella root still has none (INVENTORY.md §6.1, §6.4)	APPLY.md §6 states it. The umbrella-root carriers of INVENTORY.md §7.1 are a separate change.
R10	vasic.digital is a GitHub Pages repository — a push redeploys the live site	Four new root-level .md files land in a published static site	Flagged in APPLY.md §4.6. Whether Jekyll ignores or publishes them is unverified (§6).
R12	A staged carrier does not satisfy is_pointer_carrier() and therefore <i>adds</i> 17 MISSING verdicts instead of clearing any	This is not hypothetical: it is exactly what Revision 1 of this directory did (§0). A carrier that looks like a pointer to a human — a blockquote, a differently-worded H2 — is invisible to the predicate, which matches only a line-anchored, non-fenced ##	Mitigated and measured. Every carrier now opens with that heading; APPLY.md §5 check 5 runs the real predicate over every applied file, and check 6 re-runs all 1 gates and prints the

#	Risk	Why it exists	Mitigation in APPLY.md
		INHERITED FROM heading at column zero	fleet MISSING count PROOF.md records the before/after with a control run on the uncorrected files.
R11	vasic.digital has a commit wrapper and the constitution forbids bypassing it	AGENTS.project.md.template: “ Use the project’s commit wrapper. No direct git add / git commit / git push on main repo.” The tracked script vasic.digital/ commit exists.	APPLY.md §4.6 gives the wrapper form first and the plain-gi form as a labelled fallback, and states the wrapper’s internals were not executed or line-rea

5. Honesty flags in the prepared text

- **ai_interviewing and the decoupling sentence.** The reference CLAUDE.md form ends “This module stays fully decoupled and reusable per the Helix Constitution’s §11.4.28 ... **No project-specific context is injected here.**” Reproduced verbatim into ai_interviewing, that last sentence is contradicted by that module’s own README.md, which opens “**Interview-preparation corpus and employer due-diligence** for the CauseMatch *Senior Full-Stack Engineer, Agent-Native Development* position — built for the candidate at milosvasic.ru (Miloš Vasić)”. Naming a specific employer and a specific consuming site is precisely the “project-specific context” §11.4.28(B) forbids. Revision 1 kept the sentence for exact fidelity to the reference form and left the operator to accept or delete it. **Revision 2 removed it**, replacing it with a claim about the carrier itself, which is verifiable and was verified: “*This file therefore hardcodes no parent-project path and no depth-dependent path, keeping the module project-not-aware, decoupled and reusable per §11.4.28(B).*” That is a statement about the file the operator is committing — checked by APPLY.md §5 check 2, which greps every carrier for the umbrella layout string and finds none in any of the 20. No carrier now asserts anything about the *module’s* content, which this pass did not audit (§6). Whether ai_interviewing’s README is itself §11.4.28(B)-compliant remains an open, separate remediation item — it is simply no longer pre-judged by a sentence in the carrier.

- **INVENTORY.md §6.2/§7.3 needs a correction.** It presents `milosvasic.ru/Upstreamable/{AGENTS,CLAUDE}.md` as `milosvasic.ru`'s files. They are tracked by a **different repository**, `red-elf/Upstreamable (milosvasic.ru/.gitmodules, gitlink 94f9831b8aa0a1d4df23671d2e4600886aad0dcf)`. `milosvasic.ru` itself tracks **zero** agent-instruction files. The reference *form* is still valid and is what this propagation reproduces; only the attribution is wrong. `APPLY.md §2.1` records this. This file does not modify `INVENTORY.md`.
- **Four carriers, not two, and not five.** The reference implementation ships `AGENTS.md` + `CLAUDE.md` only. This propagation prepares four, adding `QWEN.md` and `GEMINI.md` per §11.4.157 and `INVENTORY.md §7.3`. The fifth carrier (`Constitution.md`) is deliberately **not** prepared: whether a project-unaware owned submodule must carry its own `Constitution.md` is **not specified** in `submodules/constitution/templates/`, in `README` “How to consume”, or in §11.4.28. The only `Constitution` template that ships is a *project* scaffold requiring `## Owned-submodule set` and `## Project-specific remotes`.
- **QWEN.md and GEMINI.md forms are derived, not quoted.** `submodules/constitution/templates/` contains exactly three files — `AGENTS.project.md.template`, `CLAUDE.project.md.template`, `Constitution.project.md.template`. There is **no** `QWEN.project.md.template` and **no** `GEMINI.project.md.template` (`INVENTORY.md` records this as gap G7b). The `QWEN` form is the `README`'s own instruction (“Same for `AGENTS.md` ... and (since 2026-05-20) `QWEN.md` for Qwen Code:” + the blockquote) applied to the conditional wording. The `GEMINI` form is derived from §11.4.157's first-class-carrier mandate; `submodules/constitution/GEMINI.md` does prescribe a consumer pointer, but as an unconditional `## INHERITED FROM constitution/GEMINI.md` heading and with **SHOULD**, not **MUST** (“the project's repo-root carrier **SHOULD** start with a clearly-marked inheritance pointer”) — and its unconditional wording is unusable in a project-unaware module. Where the constitution specifies nothing, this document says “not specified” rather than inventing a convention.

6. Not verified

Each item states what would settle it. None of these was guessed at above.

Item	Why unverified	What would verify it
Whether milosvasic.ru's three URLs (milosvasic.ru on GitHub, milosvasic.net.v2 on GitHub, milosvasic-net-v-2 on GitFlic) are mirrors of one repository	Requires network access; git fetch / ls-remote was forbidden	git -C milosvasic.ru ls-remote git@github.com:milos85vasic:milosvasic.ru.git compare against the two push URLs an operator statement
Whether each push URL is reachable and the credentials current	No network operation was run	git -C <sub> ls-remote <sub> per URL, before committing anything
Whether the four new root .md files would be published by vasic.digital's GitHub Pages build	Requires reading and reasoning about the site's build configuration, and ultimately a deploy	Inspect vasic.digital for _config.yml / .nojekyll and its exclude list; or push to branch and preview
What vasic.digital/commit actually does (stages all? pushes? which remotes?)	The script was not executed and was not read line-by-line	cat vasic.digital/commit and dry-run it in a scratch clone
Whether WangX0111 is genuinely external to the operator	Inferred from the org not matching any of milos85vasic / vasic-digital / HelixDevelopment	Operator confirmation, or repo view WangX0111/ superspec
Whether the five submodules' content is otherwise §11.4.28(B)-compliant (beyond the ai_interviewing README flagged in §5)	This pass surveyed carriers and remotes, not the 3,156 tracked files across the five modules for project-coupling	A §11.4.28(B) audit per module — out of scope here
Whether the constitution submodule pointer is current relative to its upstream	git fetch was forbidden	git -C submodules/ constitution fetch --all git -C submodules/ constitution log --oneline HEAD..origin/main (INVENTORY.md §10 records the same item)

Item	Why unverified	What would verify it
Whether applying this would make any existing gate pass — verified 2026-08-27; the answer is no	Superseded: scripts/verify-all-constitution-rules.sh and the 17 cm_covenant_114_*_propagation.sh gates now exist and were run. Applying this propagation leaves all 17 FAILing, held by four third-party carriers; what it changes is the MISSING count, 85 → 68, and the MISSING-carrier count, 5 → 4	Done — <code>PROOF.md</code>; re-runnable at any time with <code>APPLY.md</code> §5 check 6
Whether the constitution's own nested submodules (anti_bluff, continuum, session_orchestrator, token_optimizer, its design-toolkit, ...) need the same treatment	Out of scope — this task named the 5 umbrella-owned submodules. <code>INVENTORY.md</code> §7.3 lists them as targets	A separate decision; each such commit would push through submodules/constitution's 6-URL fan-c or those modules' own remotes